

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

MSP, Procurement, Buffer Stocks, PDS and Food Security - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

MSP, Procurement, Buffer Stocks, PDS and Food Security	
REFRESHED TEACHING NAVIGATION — BASIC/CORE FIRST	
01	FOUNDATION — MSP RECOMMENDATION AND ANNOUNCEMENT Mechanism chain: MSP announcement - CACP and CCEA Qualified
02	FOUNDATION — CACP COST CONCEPTS Technically, FOUNDATION — CACP cost concepts is analysed by
03	FOUNDATION — PROCUREMENT DEFINITION Mechanism chain: Procurement Qualified use: Balance farmer.
04	CORE — UNEVEN PROCUREMENT ACCESS Mechanism chain: Uneven procurement access Qualified use: Map
05	CORE — FCI ECONOMIC COST Mechanism chain: FCI economic cost Qualified use: Keep stock
06	CORE — BUFFER NORMS AND ACTUAL STOCKS Mechanism chain: Buffer-stock boundary - Open-market release
07	CORE — OPEN-MARKET RELEASE The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement
08	CORE — NFSA AND TPDS The owner records Priority Household entitlement per person per
09	CORE — ENTITLEMENT ACCOUNTING UNITS Mechanism chain: NFSA coverage ceilings Qualified use: Balance
10	CORE — COVERAGE CEILINGS Mechanism chain: Entitlement versus offtake Qualified use: Map food
11	CORE — ENTITLEMENT, ALLOCATION AND OFFTAKE PMGKAY uses the public-distribution architecture for free-foodgrain
12	CORE — PMGKAY STATUS DISCIPLINE End-to-end computerisation and ePoS authentication can reduce
13	CORE SYNTHESIS — ONORC PORTABILITY Technically, CORE SYNTHESIS — ONORC portability is analysed by
14	CORE SYNTHESIS — DIGITISATION AND DECENTRALISED PROCUREMENT Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or
15	CORE SYNTHESIS — PRICE STABILISATION, NUTRITION AND CROP BOUNDARIES Limit/status caution: DD Legal access to cereals does not by itself

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

MSP, Procurement, Buffer Stocks, PDS and Food Security - Solved Practice Workbook 6

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION 6

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies MSP announcement?	6
Q2. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of MSP announcement?	6
Q3. Which statement uses MSP announcement without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?	6
Q4. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about MSP announcement?	6
Q5. Which statement correctly identifies CACP and CCEA?	7
Q6. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of CACP and CCEA?	7
Q7. Which statement uses CACP and CCEA without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?	7
Q8. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about CACP and CCEA?	7
Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Cost concepts?	8
Q10. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Cost concepts?	8
Q11. Which statement uses Cost concepts without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?	8
Q12. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Cost concepts?	8
Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Procurement?	9
Q14. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Procurement?	9
Q15. Which statement uses Procurement without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?	9
Q16. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Procurement?	9
Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Uneven procurement access?	10
Q18. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Uneven procurement access?	10
Q19. Which statement uses Uneven procurement access without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?	10
Q20. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Uneven procurement access?	10
Q21. Which statement correctly identifies FCI economic cost?	11
Q22. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of FCI economic cost?	11
Q23. Which statement uses FCI economic cost without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?	11
Q24. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about FCI economic cost?	11
Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Buffer-stock boundary?	12
Q26. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Buffer-stock boundary?	12
Q27. Which statement uses Buffer-stock boundary without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?	12

Q28. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Buffer-stock boundary?	12
Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Open-market release?	13
Q30. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Open-market release?	13
Q31. Which statement uses Open-market release without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?	13
Q32. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Open-market release?	13
Q33. Which statement correctly identifies NFSA and TPDS?	14
Q34. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of NFSA and TPDS?	14
Q35. Which statement uses NFSA and TPDS without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?	14
Q36. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about NFSA and TPDS?	14
Q37. Which statement correctly identifies NFSA entitlement units?	15
Q38. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of NFSA entitlement units?	15
Q39. Which statement uses NFSA entitlement units without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?	15
Q40. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about NFSA entitlement units?	15
Q41. Which statement correctly identifies NFSA coverage ceilings?	16
Q42. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of NFSA coverage ceilings?	16
Q43. Which statement uses NFSA coverage ceilings without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?	16
Q44. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about NFSA coverage ceilings?	17
Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Entitlement versus offtake?	17
Q46. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Entitlement versus offtake?	17
Q47. Which statement uses Entitlement versus offtake without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?	17
Q48. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Entitlement versus offtake?	18
Q49. Which statement correctly identifies PMGKAY status?	18
Q50. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of PMGKAY status?	18
Q51. Which statement uses PMGKAY status without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?	18
Q52. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about PMGKAY status?	19
Q53. Which statement correctly identifies ONORC portability?	19
Q54. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of ONORC portability?	19
Q55. Which statement uses ONORC portability without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?	19
Q56. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about ONORC portability?	20
Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Digitisation trade-off?	20
Q58. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Digitisation trade-off?	20
Q59. Which statement uses Digitisation trade-off without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?	20

Q60. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Digitisation trade-off?	21
Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Decentralised procurement?	21
Q62. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Decentralised procurement?	21
Q63. Which statement uses Decentralised procurement without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?	21
Q64. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Decentralised procurement?	22
Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Price stabilisation?	22
Q66. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Price stabilisation?	22
Q67. Which statement uses Price stabilisation without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?	22
Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Price stabilisation?	23
Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Nutrition dimensions?	23
Q70. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Nutrition dimensions?	23
Q71. Which statement uses Nutrition dimensions without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?	23
Q72. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Nutrition dimensions?	24
Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Oilseed procurement boundary?	24
Q74. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Oilseed procurement boundary?	24
Q75. Which statement uses Oilseed procurement boundary without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?	24
Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Oilseed procurement boundary?	25
Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Crop-list and millet caution?	25
Q78. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Crop-list and millet caution?	25
Q79. Which statement uses Crop-list and millet caution without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?	25
Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Crop-list and millet caution?	26

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE 26

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT	26
OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS	26
PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2018 GS-III	30
PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2019 GS-III	31
PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2021 GS-III	32
PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2022 GS-III	34
PYQ DEMAND CARD 5 - 2024 GS-III	35
PYQ DEMAND CARD 6 - 2024 GS-III	36
ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS	37
ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS	40

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS 41

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS 44

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS 47

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS 51

MSP, Procurement, Buffer Stocks, PDS and Food Security - Solved Practice Workbook

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies MSP announcement?

A. Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee. B. Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification. C. The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends MSPs, while the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs takes the Union-level announcement decision; recommendation and decision are distinct stages. D. A2 records paid-out expenses, A2+FL adds imputed family labour, and C2 further includes imputed rent on owned land and interest on owned fixed capital; the named base matters to any margin claim.

Answer: A. Explanation: Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q2. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of MSP announcement?

A. Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification. B. Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee. C. Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures. D. A2 records paid-out expenses, A2+FL adds imputed family labour, and C2 further includes imputed rent on owned land and interest on owned fixed capital; the named base matters to any margin claim.

Answer: B. Explanation: Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q3. Which statement uses MSP announcement without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures. B. Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification. C. Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee. D. FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain.

Answer: C. Explanation: Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q4. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about MSP announcement?

A. Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures. B. Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date. C. FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain. D. Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee.

Answer: D. Explanation: Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee. The other options

belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies CACP and CCEA?

A. The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends MSPs, while the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs takes the Union-level announcement decision; recommendation and decision are distinct stages. B. Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures. C. Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification. D. A2 records paid-out expenses, A2+FL adds imputed family labour, and C2 further includes imputed rent on owned land and interest on owned fixed capital; the named base matters to any margin claim.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends MSPs, while the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs takes the Union-level announcement decision; recommendation and decision are distinct stages. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q6. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of CACP and CCEA?

A. Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification. B. The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends MSPs, while the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs takes the Union-level announcement decision; recommendation and decision are distinct stages. C. Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures. D. FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends MSPs, while the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs takes the Union-level announcement decision; recommendation and decision are distinct stages. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q7. Which statement uses CACP and CCEA without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date. B. Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures. C. The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends MSPs, while the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs takes the Union-level announcement decision; recommendation and decision are distinct stages. D. FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends MSPs, while the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs takes the Union-level announcement decision; recommendation and decision are distinct stages. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q8. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about CACP and CCEA?

A. Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date. B. Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct. C. FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain. D. The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends MSPs, while the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs takes the Union-level announcement decision; recommendation and decision are distinct stages.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends MSPs, while the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs takes the Union-level announcement decision; recommendation and decision are distinct stages. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments,

institutions or legal perimeters.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Cost concepts?

A. A2 records paid-out expenses, A2+FL adds imputed family labour, and C2 further includes imputed rent on owned land and interest on owned fixed capital; the named base matters to any margin claim. B. FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain. C. Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification. D. Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures.

Answer: A. Explanation: A2 records paid-out expenses, A2+FL adds imputed family labour, and C2 further includes imputed rent on owned land and interest on owned fixed capital; the named base matters to any margin claim. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q10. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Cost concepts?

A. Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures. B. A2 records paid-out expenses, A2+FL adds imputed family labour, and C2 further includes imputed rent on owned land and interest on owned fixed capital; the named base matters to any margin claim. C. Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date. D. FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain.

Answer: B. Explanation: A2 records paid-out expenses, A2+FL adds imputed family labour, and C2 further includes imputed rent on owned land and interest on owned fixed capital; the named base matters to any margin claim. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q11. Which statement uses Cost concepts without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date. B. Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct. C. A2 records paid-out expenses, A2+FL adds imputed family labour, and C2 further includes imputed rent on owned land and interest on owned fixed capital; the named base matters to any margin claim. D. FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain.

Answer: C. Explanation: A2 records paid-out expenses, A2+FL adds imputed family labour, and C2 further includes imputed rent on owned land and interest on owned fixed capital; the named base matters to any margin claim. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q12. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Cost concepts?

A. Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date. B. The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. C. Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct. D. A2 records paid-out expenses, A2+FL adds imputed family labour, and C2 further includes imputed rent on owned land and interest on owned fixed capital; the named base matters to any margin claim.

Answer: D. Explanation: A2 records paid-out expenses, A2+FL adds imputed family labour, and C2 further includes imputed rent on owned land and interest on owned fixed capital; the named base matters to any margin claim. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Procurement?

A. Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification. B. Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures. C. FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain. D. Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date.

Answer: A. Explanation: Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q14. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Procurement?

A. Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct. B. Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification. C. FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain. D. Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date.

Answer: B. Explanation: Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q15. Which statement uses Procurement without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct. B. The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. C. Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification. D. Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date.

Answer: C. Explanation: Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q16. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Procurement?

A. Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct. B. The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. C. The owner records Priority Household entitlement per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana entitlement per household per month, so beneficiary category and accounting unit must not be mixed. D. Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification.

Answer: D. Explanation: Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Uneven procurement access?

A. Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures. B. FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain. C. Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date. D. Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct.

Answer: A. Explanation: Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q18. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Uneven procurement access?

A. Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct. B. Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures. C. Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date. D. The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical.

Answer: B. Explanation: Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q19. Which statement uses Uneven procurement access without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct. B. The owner records Priority Household entitlement per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana entitlement per household per month, so beneficiary category and accounting unit must not be mixed. C. Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures. D. The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical.

Answer: C. Explanation: Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q20. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Uneven procurement access?

A. The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. B. The owner records NFSA coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent of rural population and 50 per cent of urban population; ceilings are not identical to actual enrolled beneficiaries in each state. C. The owner records Priority Household entitlement per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana entitlement per household per month, so beneficiary category and accounting unit must not be mixed. D. Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures.

Answer: D. Explanation: Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies FCI economic cost?

A. FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain. B. The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. C. Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct. D. Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date.

Answer: A. Explanation: FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q22. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of FCI economic cost?

A. Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct. B. FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain. C. The owner records Priority Household entitlement per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana entitlement per household per month, so beneficiary category and accounting unit must not be mixed. D. The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical.

Answer: B. Explanation: FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q23. Which statement uses FCI economic cost without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The owner records NFSA coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent of rural population and 50 per cent of urban population; ceilings are not identical to actual enrolled beneficiaries in each state. B. The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. C. FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain. D. The owner records Priority Household entitlement per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana entitlement per household per month, so beneficiary category and accounting unit must not be mixed.

Answer: C. Explanation: FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q24. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about FCI economic cost?

A. A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. B. The owner records Priority Household entitlement per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana entitlement per household per month, so beneficiary category and accounting unit must not be mixed. C. The owner records NFSA coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent of rural population and 50 per cent of urban population; ceilings are not identical to actual enrolled beneficiaries in each state. D. FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain.

Answer: D. Explanation: FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Buffer-stock boundary?

A. Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date. B. Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct. C. The owner records Priority Household entitlement per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana entitlement per household per month, so beneficiary category and accounting unit must not be mixed. D. The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical.

Answer: A. Explanation: Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q26. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Buffer-stock boundary?

A. The owner records NFSA coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent of rural population and 50 per cent of urban population; ceilings are not identical to actual enrolled beneficiaries in each state. B. Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date. C. The owner records Priority Household entitlement per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana entitlement per household per month, so beneficiary category and accounting unit must not be mixed. D. The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical.

Answer: B. Explanation: Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q27. Which statement uses Buffer-stock boundary without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The owner records NFSA coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent of rural population and 50 per cent of urban population; ceilings are not identical to actual enrolled beneficiaries in each state. B. A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. C. Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date. D. The owner records Priority Household entitlement per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana entitlement per household per month, so beneficiary category and accounting unit must not be mixed.

Answer: C. Explanation: Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q28. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Buffer-stock boundary?

A. A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. B. The owner records NFSA coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent of rural population and 50 per cent of urban population; ceilings are not identical to actual enrolled beneficiaries in each state. C. PMGKAY uses the public-distribution architecture for free-foodgrain support, but continuation, merger and beneficiary-period claims are executive-status questions that require a dated notification. D. Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date.

Answer: D. Explanation: Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Open-market release?

A. Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct. B. The owner records Priority Household entitlement per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana entitlement per household per month, so beneficiary category and accounting unit must not be mixed. C. The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. D. The owner records NFSA coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent of rural population and 50 per cent of urban population; ceilings are not identical to actual enrolled beneficiaries in each state.

Answer: A. Explanation: Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q30. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Open-market release?

A. The owner records Priority Household entitlement per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana entitlement per household per month, so beneficiary category and accounting unit must not be mixed. B. Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct. C. The owner records NFSA coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent of rural population and 50 per cent of urban population; ceilings are not identical to actual enrolled beneficiaries in each state. D. A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure.

Answer: B. Explanation: Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q31. Which statement uses Open-market release without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. B. PMGKAY uses the public-distribution architecture for free-foodgrain support, but continuation, merger and beneficiary-period claims are executive-status questions that require a dated notification. C. Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct. D. The owner records NFSA coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent of rural population and 50 per cent of urban population; ceilings are not identical to actual enrolled beneficiaries in each state.

Answer: C. Explanation: Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q32. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Open-market release?

A. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability within the NFSA delivery architecture, but portability use depends on beneficiary awareness, identity matching, ePoS connectivity and stock availability. B. A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. C. PMGKAY uses the public-distribution architecture for free-foodgrain support, but continuation, merger and beneficiary-period claims are executive-status questions that require a dated notification. D. Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct.

Answer: D. Explanation: Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

perimeters.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies NFSA and TPDS?

A. The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. B. The owner records Priority Household entitlement per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana entitlement per household per month, so beneficiary category and accounting unit must not be mixed. C. The owner records NFSA coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent of rural population and 50 per cent of urban population; ceilings are not identical to actual enrolled beneficiaries in each state. D. A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure.

Answer: A. Explanation: The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q34. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of NFSA and TPDS?

A. The owner records NFSA coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent of rural population and 50 per cent of urban population; ceilings are not identical to actual enrolled beneficiaries in each state. B. The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. C. A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. D. PMGKAY uses the public-distribution architecture for free-foodgrain support, but continuation, merger and beneficiary-period claims are executive-status questions that require a dated notification.

Answer: B. Explanation: The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q35. Which statement uses NFSA and TPDS without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. B. PMGKAY uses the public-distribution architecture for free-foodgrain support, but continuation, merger and beneficiary-period claims are executive-status questions that require a dated notification. C. The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. D. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability within the NFSA delivery architecture, but portability use depends on beneficiary awareness, identity matching, ePoS connectivity and stock availability.

Answer: C. Explanation: The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q36. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about NFSA and TPDS?

A. PMGKAY uses the public-distribution architecture for free-foodgrain support, but continuation, merger and beneficiary-period claims are executive-status questions that require a dated notification. B. End-to-end computerisation and ePoS authentication can reduce duplicate records and diversion, while device, connectivity, seeding or biometric failure can exclude genuine beneficiaries. C. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability within the NFSA delivery architecture, but portability use depends on beneficiary awareness, identity matching, ePoS connectivity and stock availability. D. The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical.

Answer: D. Explanation: The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not

identical. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies NFSA entitlement units?

A. The owner records Priority Household entitlement per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana entitlement per household per month, so beneficiary category and accounting unit must not be mixed. B. PMGKAY uses the public-distribution architecture for free-foodgrain support, but continuation, merger and beneficiary-period claims are executive-status questions that require a dated notification. C. A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. D. The owner records NFSA coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent of rural population and 50 per cent of urban population; ceilings are not identical to actual enrolled beneficiaries in each state.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owner records Priority Household entitlement per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana entitlement per household per month, so beneficiary category and accounting unit must not be mixed. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q38. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of NFSA entitlement units?

A. PMGKAY uses the public-distribution architecture for free-foodgrain support, but continuation, merger and beneficiary-period claims are executive-status questions that require a dated notification. B. The owner records Priority Household entitlement per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana entitlement per household per month, so beneficiary category and accounting unit must not be mixed. C. A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. D. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability within the NFSA delivery architecture, but portability use depends on beneficiary awareness, identity matching, ePoS connectivity and stock availability.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owner records Priority Household entitlement per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana entitlement per household per month, so beneficiary category and accounting unit must not be mixed. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q39. Which statement uses NFSA entitlement units without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability within the NFSA delivery architecture, but portability use depends on beneficiary awareness, identity matching, ePoS connectivity and stock availability. B. PMGKAY uses the public-distribution architecture for free-foodgrain support, but continuation, merger and beneficiary-period claims are executive-status questions that require a dated notification. C. The owner records Priority Household entitlement per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana entitlement per household per month, so beneficiary category and accounting unit must not be mixed. D. End-to-end computerisation and ePoS authentication can reduce duplicate records and diversion, while device, connectivity, seeding or biometric failure can exclude genuine beneficiaries.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owner records Priority Household entitlement per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana entitlement per household per month, so beneficiary category and accounting unit must not be mixed. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q40. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about NFSA entitlement units?

A. End-to-end computerisation and ePoS authentication can reduce duplicate records and diversion, while device, connectivity, seeding or biometric failure can exclude genuine beneficiaries. B. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability within the NFSA delivery architecture, but portability use depends on beneficiary awareness, identity matching, ePoS connectivity and stock availability. C. Decentralised procurement gives participating states a larger operational role in purchase, storage and distribution, without eliminating Union financing, stock-transfer or quality questions. D. The owner records Priority Household entitlement per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana entitlement per household per month, so beneficiary category and accounting unit must not be mixed.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owner records Priority Household entitlement per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana entitlement per household per month, so beneficiary category and accounting unit must not be mixed. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies NFSA coverage ceilings?

A. The owner records NFSA coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent of rural population and 50 per cent of urban population; ceilings are not identical to actual enrolled beneficiaries in each state. B. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability within the NFSA delivery architecture, but portability use depends on beneficiary awareness, identity matching, ePoS connectivity and stock availability. C. A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. D. PMGKAY uses the public-distribution architecture for free-foodgrain support, but continuation, merger and beneficiary-period claims are executive-status questions that require a dated notification.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owner records NFSA coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent of rural population and 50 per cent of urban population; ceilings are not identical to actual enrolled beneficiaries in each state. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q42. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of NFSA coverage ceilings?

A. PMGKAY uses the public-distribution architecture for free-foodgrain support, but continuation, merger and beneficiary-period claims are executive-status questions that require a dated notification. B. The owner records NFSA coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent of rural population and 50 per cent of urban population; ceilings are not identical to actual enrolled beneficiaries in each state. C. End-to-end computerisation and ePoS authentication can reduce duplicate records and diversion, while device, connectivity, seeding or biometric failure can exclude genuine beneficiaries. D. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability within the NFSA delivery architecture, but portability use depends on beneficiary awareness, identity matching, ePoS connectivity and stock availability.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owner records NFSA coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent of rural population and 50 per cent of urban population; ceilings are not identical to actual enrolled beneficiaries in each state. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q43. Which statement uses NFSA coverage ceilings without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. End-to-end computerisation and ePoS authentication can reduce duplicate records and diversion, while device, connectivity, seeding or biometric failure can exclude genuine beneficiaries. B. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability within the NFSA delivery architecture, but portability use depends on beneficiary awareness, identity matching, ePoS connectivity and stock availability. C. The owner records NFSA coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent of rural population and 50 per cent of urban population; ceilings are not identical to actual enrolled beneficiaries in each state. D. Decentralised procurement gives participating states a larger operational role in purchase, storage and distribution, without eliminating Union financing, stock-transfer or quality questions.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owner records NFSA coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent of rural population and 50 per cent of urban population; ceilings are not identical to actual enrolled beneficiaries in each state. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q44. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about NFSA coverage ceilings?

A. Public purchase can support farm prices and later stock release can moderate consumer prices, but excessive or unpredictable intervention can crowd private storage and distort crop choice. B. Decentralised procurement gives participating states a larger operational role in purchase, storage and distribution, without eliminating Union financing, stock-transfer or quality questions. C. End-to-end computerisation and ePoS authentication can reduce duplicate records and diversion, while device, connectivity, seeding or biometric failure can exclude genuine beneficiaries. D. The owner records NFSA coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent of rural population and 50 per cent of urban population; ceilings are not identical to actual enrolled beneficiaries in each state.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owner records NFSA coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent of rural population and 50 per cent of urban population; ceilings are not identical to actual enrolled beneficiaries in each state. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Entitlement versus offtake?

A. A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. B. End-to-end computerisation and ePoS authentication can reduce duplicate records and diversion, while device, connectivity, seeding or biometric failure can exclude genuine beneficiaries. C. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability within the NFSA delivery architecture, but portability use depends on beneficiary awareness, identity matching, ePoS connectivity and stock availability. D. PMGKAY uses the public-distribution architecture for free-foodgrain support, but continuation, merger and beneficiary-period claims are executive-status questions that require a dated notification.

Answer: A. Explanation: A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q46. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Entitlement versus offtake?

A. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability within the NFSA delivery architecture, but portability use depends on beneficiary awareness, identity matching, ePoS connectivity and stock availability. B. A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. C. End-to-end computerisation and ePoS authentication can reduce duplicate records and diversion, while device, connectivity, seeding or biometric failure can exclude genuine beneficiaries. D. Decentralised procurement gives participating states a larger operational role in purchase, storage and distribution, without eliminating Union financing, stock-transfer or quality questions.

Answer: B. Explanation: A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q47. Which statement uses Entitlement versus offtake without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. End-to-end computerisation and ePoS authentication can reduce duplicate records and diversion, while device, connectivity, seeding or biometric failure can exclude genuine beneficiaries. B. Public purchase can support farm prices and later stock release can moderate consumer prices, but excessive or unpredictable intervention can crowd private storage and distort crop choice. C. A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. D. Decentralised procurement gives participating states a larger operational role in purchase, storage and distribution, without eliminating Union financing, stock-transfer or quality questions.

Answer: C. Explanation: A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q48. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Entitlement versus offtake?

A. Public purchase can support farm prices and later stock release can moderate consumer prices, but excessive or unpredictable intervention can crowd private storage and distort crop choice. B. Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care. C. Decentralised procurement gives participating states a larger operational role in purchase, storage and distribution, without eliminating Union financing, stock-transfer or quality questions. D. A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure.

Answer: D. Explanation: A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies PMGKAY status?

A. PMGKAY uses the public-distribution architecture for free-foodgrain support, but continuation, merger and beneficiary-period claims are executive-status questions that require a dated notification. B. Decentralised procurement gives participating states a larger operational role in purchase, storage and distribution, without eliminating Union financing, stock-transfer or quality questions. C. End-to-end computerisation and ePoS authentication can reduce duplicate records and diversion, while device, connectivity, seeding or biometric failure can exclude genuine beneficiaries. D. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability within the NFSA delivery architecture, but portability use depends on beneficiary awareness, identity matching, ePoS connectivity and stock availability.

Answer: A. Explanation: PMGKAY uses the public-distribution architecture for free-foodgrain support, but continuation, merger and beneficiary-period claims are executive-status questions that require a dated notification. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q50. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of PMGKAY status?

A. Public purchase can support farm prices and later stock release can moderate consumer prices, but excessive or unpredictable intervention can crowd private storage and distort crop choice. B. PMGKAY uses the public-distribution architecture for free-foodgrain support, but continuation, merger and beneficiary-period claims are executive-status questions that require a dated notification. C. Decentralised procurement gives participating states a larger operational role in purchase, storage and distribution, without eliminating Union financing, stock-transfer or quality questions. D. End-to-end computerisation and ePoS authentication can reduce duplicate records and diversion, while device, connectivity, seeding or biometric failure can exclude genuine beneficiaries.

Answer: B. Explanation: PMGKAY uses the public-distribution architecture for free-foodgrain support, but continuation, merger and beneficiary-period claims are executive-status questions that require a dated notification. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q51. Which statement uses PMGKAY status without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care. B. Public purchase can support farm prices and later stock release can moderate consumer prices, but excessive or unpredictable intervention can crowd private storage and distort crop choice. C. PMGKAY uses the public-distribution architecture for free-foodgrain support, but continuation, merger and beneficiary-period claims are executive-status questions that require a dated notification. D. Decentralised procurement gives participating states a larger operational role in purchase, storage and distribution, without eliminating Union financing, stock-transfer or quality questions.

Answer: C. Explanation: PMGKAY uses the public-distribution architecture for free-foodgrain support, but continuation, merger and beneficiary-period claims are executive-status questions that require a dated notification. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q52. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about PMGKAY status?

A. Public purchase can support farm prices and later stock release can moderate consumer prices, but excessive or unpredictable intervention can crowd private storage and distort crop choice. B. Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care. C. Oilseed procurement is not an everywhere-unlimited operation equivalent to classic paddy-wheat procurement; agency operations, arrivals and scheme conditions determine actual purchase. D. PMGKAY uses the public-distribution architecture for free-foodgrain support, but continuation, merger and beneficiary-period claims are executive-status questions that require a dated notification.

Answer: D. Explanation: PMGKAY uses the public-distribution architecture for free-foodgrain support, but continuation, merger and beneficiary-period claims are executive-status questions that require a dated notification. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies ONORC portability?

A. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability within the NFSA delivery architecture, but portability use depends on beneficiary awareness, identity matching, ePoS connectivity and stock availability. B. Decentralised procurement gives participating states a larger operational role in purchase, storage and distribution, without eliminating Union financing, stock-transfer or quality questions. C. Public purchase can support farm prices and later stock release can moderate consumer prices, but excessive or unpredictable intervention can crowd private storage and distort crop choice. D. End-to-end computerisation and ePoS authentication can reduce duplicate records and diversion, while device, connectivity, seeding or biometric failure can exclude genuine beneficiaries.

Answer: A. Explanation: One Nation One Ration Card enables portability within the NFSA delivery architecture, but portability use depends on beneficiary awareness, identity matching, ePoS connectivity and stock availability. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q54. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of ONORC portability?

A. Decentralised procurement gives participating states a larger operational role in purchase, storage and distribution, without eliminating Union financing, stock-transfer or quality questions. B. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability within the NFSA delivery architecture, but portability use depends on beneficiary awareness, identity matching, ePoS connectivity and stock availability. C. Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care. D. Public purchase can support farm prices and later stock release can moderate consumer prices, but excessive or unpredictable intervention can crowd private storage and distort crop choice.

Answer: B. Explanation: One Nation One Ration Card enables portability within the NFSA delivery architecture, but portability use depends on beneficiary awareness, identity matching, ePoS connectivity and stock availability. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q55. Which statement uses ONORC portability without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Oilseed procurement is not an everywhere-unlimited operation equivalent to classic paddy-wheat procurement; agency operations, arrivals and scheme conditions determine actual purchase. B. Public purchase can support farm prices and later stock release can moderate consumer prices, but excessive or unpredictable intervention can crowd private storage and distort crop choice. C. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability within the NFSA delivery architecture, but portability use depends on beneficiary awareness, identity matching, ePoS connectivity and stock availability. D. Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care.

Answer: C. Explanation: One Nation One Ration Card enables portability within the NFSA delivery architecture, but portability use depends on beneficiary awareness, identity matching, ePoS connectivity and stock availability. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q56. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about ONORC portability?

A. Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care. B. The owner distinguishes notified price-support crops, sugarcane's separate FRP mechanism and millet or niger-seed questions; exact current lists, rates and season claims require the relevant notification. C. Oilseed procurement is not an everywhere-unlimited operation equivalent to classic paddy-wheat procurement; agency operations, arrivals and scheme conditions determine actual purchase. D. One Nation One Ration Card enables portability within the NFSA delivery architecture, but portability use depends on beneficiary awareness, identity matching, ePoS connectivity and stock availability.

Answer: D. Explanation: One Nation One Ration Card enables portability within the NFSA delivery architecture, but portability use depends on beneficiary awareness, identity matching, ePoS connectivity and stock availability. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Digitisation trade-off?

A. End-to-end computerisation and ePoS authentication can reduce duplicate records and diversion, while device, connectivity, seeding or biometric failure can exclude genuine beneficiaries. B. Decentralised procurement gives participating states a larger operational role in purchase, storage and distribution, without eliminating Union financing, stock-transfer or quality questions. C. Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care. D. Public purchase can support farm prices and later stock release can moderate consumer prices, but excessive or unpredictable intervention can crowd private storage and distort crop choice.

Answer: A. Explanation: End-to-end computerisation and ePoS authentication can reduce duplicate records and diversion, while device, connectivity, seeding or biometric failure can exclude genuine beneficiaries. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q58. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Digitisation trade-off?

A. Oilseed procurement is not an everywhere-unlimited operation equivalent to classic paddy-wheat procurement; agency operations, arrivals and scheme conditions determine actual purchase. B. End-to-end computerisation and ePoS authentication can reduce duplicate records and diversion, while device, connectivity, seeding or biometric failure can exclude genuine beneficiaries. C. Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care. D. Public purchase can support farm prices and later stock release can moderate consumer prices, but excessive or unpredictable intervention can crowd private storage and distort crop choice.

Answer: B. Explanation: End-to-end computerisation and ePoS authentication can reduce duplicate records and diversion, while device, connectivity, seeding or biometric failure can exclude genuine beneficiaries. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q59. Which statement uses Digitisation trade-off without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The owner distinguishes notified price-support crops, sugarcane's separate FRP mechanism and millet or niger-seed questions; exact current lists, rates and season claims require the relevant notification. B. Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care. C. End-to-end computerisation and ePoS authentication can reduce duplicate records and diversion, while device, connectivity, seeding or biometric failure can exclude genuine beneficiaries. D. Oilseed procurement is not an everywhere-unlimited operation equivalent to classic paddy-wheat procurement; agency operations, arrivals and scheme conditions determine actual purchase.

Answer: C. Explanation: End-to-end computerisation and ePoS authentication can reduce duplicate records and diversion, while device, connectivity, seeding or biometric failure can exclude genuine beneficiaries. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q60. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Digitisation trade-off?

A. Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee. B. The owner distinguishes notified price-support crops, sugarcane's separate FRP mechanism and millet or niger-seed questions; exact current lists, rates and season claims require the relevant notification. C. Oilseed procurement is not an everywhere-unlimited operation equivalent to classic paddy-wheat procurement; agency operations, arrivals and scheme conditions determine actual purchase. D. End-to-end computerisation and ePoS authentication can reduce duplicate records and diversion, while device, connectivity, seeding or biometric failure can exclude genuine beneficiaries.

Answer: D. Explanation: End-to-end computerisation and ePoS authentication can reduce duplicate records and diversion, while device, connectivity, seeding or biometric failure can exclude genuine beneficiaries. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Decentralised procurement?

A. Decentralised procurement gives participating states a larger operational role in purchase, storage and distribution, without eliminating Union financing, stock-transfer or quality questions. B. Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care. C. Oilseed procurement is not an everywhere-unlimited operation equivalent to classic paddy-wheat procurement; agency operations, arrivals and scheme conditions determine actual purchase. D. Public purchase can support farm prices and later stock release can moderate consumer prices, but excessive or unpredictable intervention can crowd private storage and distort crop choice.

Answer: A. Explanation: Decentralised procurement gives participating states a larger operational role in purchase, storage and distribution, without eliminating Union financing, stock-transfer or quality questions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q62. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Decentralised procurement?

A. Oilseed procurement is not an everywhere-unlimited operation equivalent to classic paddy-wheat procurement; agency operations, arrivals and scheme conditions determine actual purchase. B. Decentralised procurement gives participating states a larger operational role in purchase, storage and distribution, without eliminating Union financing, stock-transfer or quality questions. C. The owner distinguishes notified price-support crops, sugarcane's separate FRP mechanism and millet or niger-seed questions; exact current lists, rates and season claims require the relevant notification. D. Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care.

Answer: B. Explanation: Decentralised procurement gives participating states a larger operational role in purchase, storage and distribution, without eliminating Union financing, stock-transfer or quality questions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q63. Which statement uses Decentralised procurement without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The owner distinguishes notified price-support crops, sugarcane's separate FRP mechanism and millet or niger-seed questions; exact current lists, rates and season claims require the relevant notification. B. Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee. C. Decentralised procurement gives participating states a larger operational role in purchase, storage and distribution, without eliminating Union financing, stock-transfer or quality questions. D. Oilseed procurement is not an everywhere-unlimited operation equivalent to classic paddy-wheat procurement; agency operations, arrivals and scheme conditions determine actual purchase.

Answer: C. Explanation: Decentralised procurement gives participating states a larger operational role in purchase, storage and distribution, without eliminating Union financing, stock-transfer or quality questions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal

perimeters.

Q64. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Decentralised procurement?

A. Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee. B. The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends MSPs, while the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs takes the Union-level announcement decision; recommendation and decision are distinct stages. C. The owner distinguishes notified price-support crops, sugarcane's separate FRP mechanism and millet or niger-seed questions; exact current lists, rates and season claims require the relevant notification. D. Decentralised procurement gives participating states a larger operational role in purchase, storage and distribution, without eliminating Union financing, stock-transfer or quality questions.

Answer: D. Explanation: Decentralised procurement gives participating states a larger operational role in purchase, storage and distribution, without eliminating Union financing, stock-transfer or quality questions. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Price stabilisation?

A. Public purchase can support farm prices and later stock release can moderate consumer prices, but excessive or unpredictable intervention can crowd private storage and distort crop choice. B. Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care. C. The owner distinguishes notified price-support crops, sugarcane's separate FRP mechanism and millet or niger-seed questions; exact current lists, rates and season claims require the relevant notification. D. Oilseed procurement is not an everywhere-unlimited operation equivalent to classic paddy-wheat procurement; agency operations, arrivals and scheme conditions determine actual purchase.

Answer: A. Explanation: Public purchase can support farm prices and later stock release can moderate consumer prices, but excessive or unpredictable intervention can crowd private storage and distort crop choice. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q66. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Price stabilisation?

A. Oilseed procurement is not an everywhere-unlimited operation equivalent to classic paddy-wheat procurement; agency operations, arrivals and scheme conditions determine actual purchase. B. Public purchase can support farm prices and later stock release can moderate consumer prices, but excessive or unpredictable intervention can crowd private storage and distort crop choice. C. Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee. D. The owner distinguishes notified price-support crops, sugarcane's separate FRP mechanism and millet or niger-seed questions; exact current lists, rates and season claims require the relevant notification.

Answer: B. Explanation: Public purchase can support farm prices and later stock release can moderate consumer prices, but excessive or unpredictable intervention can crowd private storage and distort crop choice. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q67. Which statement uses Price stabilisation without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. The owner distinguishes notified price-support crops, sugarcane's separate FRP mechanism and millet or niger-seed questions; exact current lists, rates and season claims require the relevant notification. B. Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee. C. Public purchase can support farm prices and later stock release can moderate consumer prices, but excessive or unpredictable intervention can crowd private storage and distort crop choice. D. The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends MSPs, while the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs takes the Union-level announcement decision; recommendation and decision are distinct stages.

Answer: C. Explanation: Public purchase can support farm prices and later stock release can moderate consumer prices, but excessive or unpredictable intervention can crowd private storage and distort crop

choice. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q68. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Price stabilisation?

A. A2 records paid-out expenses, A2+FL adds imputed family labour, and C2 further includes imputed rent on owned land and interest on owned fixed capital; the named base matters to any margin claim. B. The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends MSPs, while the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs takes the Union-level announcement decision; recommendation and decision are distinct stages. C. Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee. D. Public purchase can support farm prices and later stock release can moderate consumer prices, but excessive or unpredictable intervention can crowd private storage and distort crop choice.

Answer: D. Explanation: Public purchase can support farm prices and later stock release can moderate consumer prices, but excessive or unpredictable intervention can crowd private storage and distort crop choice. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Nutrition dimensions?

A. Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care. B. Oilseed procurement is not an everywhere-unlimited operation equivalent to classic paddy-wheat procurement; agency operations, arrivals and scheme conditions determine actual purchase. C. Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee. D. The owner distinguishes notified price-support crops, sugarcane's separate FRP mechanism and millet or niger-seed questions; exact current lists, rates and season claims require the relevant notification.

Answer: A. Explanation: Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q70. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Nutrition dimensions?

A. The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends MSPs, while the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs takes the Union-level announcement decision; recommendation and decision are distinct stages. B. Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care. C. Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee. D. The owner distinguishes notified price-support crops, sugarcane's separate FRP mechanism and millet or niger-seed questions; exact current lists, rates and season claims require the relevant notification.

Answer: B. Explanation: Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q71. Which statement uses Nutrition dimensions without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee. B. The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends MSPs, while the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs takes the Union-level announcement decision; recommendation and decision are distinct stages. C. Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care. D. A2 records paid-out expenses, A2+FL adds imputed family labour, and C2 further includes imputed rent on owned land and interest on owned fixed capital; the named base matters to any margin claim.

Answer: C. Explanation: Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q72. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Nutrition dimensions?

A. The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends MSPs, while the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs takes the Union-level announcement decision; recommendation and decision are distinct stages. B. Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification. C. A2 records paid-out expenses, A2+FL adds imputed family labour, and C2 further includes imputed rent on owned land and interest on owned fixed capital; the named base matters to any margin claim. D. Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care.

Answer: D. Explanation: Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Oilseed procurement boundary?

A. Oilseed procurement is not an everywhere-unlimited operation equivalent to classic paddy-wheat procurement; agency operations, arrivals and scheme conditions determine actual purchase. B. Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee. C. The owner distinguishes notified price-support crops, sugarcane's separate FRP mechanism and millet or niger-seed questions; exact current lists, rates and season claims require the relevant notification. D. The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends MSPs, while the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs takes the Union-level announcement decision; recommendation and decision are distinct stages.

Answer: A. Explanation: Oilseed procurement is not an everywhere-unlimited operation equivalent to classic paddy-wheat procurement; agency operations, arrivals and scheme conditions determine actual purchase. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q74. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Oilseed procurement boundary?

A. A2 records paid-out expenses, A2+FL adds imputed family labour, and C2 further includes imputed rent on owned land and interest on owned fixed capital; the named base matters to any margin claim. B. Oilseed procurement is not an everywhere-unlimited operation equivalent to classic paddy-wheat procurement; agency operations, arrivals and scheme conditions determine actual purchase. C. Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee. D. The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends MSPs, while the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs takes the Union-level announcement decision; recommendation and decision are distinct stages.

Answer: B. Explanation: Oilseed procurement is not an everywhere-unlimited operation equivalent to classic paddy-wheat procurement; agency operations, arrivals and scheme conditions determine actual purchase. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q75. Which statement uses Oilseed procurement boundary without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. A2 records paid-out expenses, A2+FL adds imputed family labour, and C2 further includes imputed rent on owned land and interest on owned fixed capital; the named base matters to any margin claim. B. The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends MSPs, while the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs takes the Union-level announcement decision; recommendation and decision are distinct stages. C. Oilseed procurement is not an everywhere-unlimited operation equivalent to classic paddy-wheat procurement; agency operations, arrivals and scheme conditions determine actual purchase. D. Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification.

Answer: C. Explanation: Oilseed procurement is not an everywhere-unlimited operation equivalent to classic paddy-wheat procurement; agency operations, arrivals and scheme conditions determine actual purchase. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

perimeters.

Q76. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Oilseed procurement boundary?

A. Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification. B. Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures. C. A2 records paid-out expenses, A2+FL adds imputed family labour, and C2 further includes imputed rent on owned land and interest on owned fixed capital; the named base matters to any margin claim. D. Oilseed procurement is not an everywhere-unlimited operation equivalent to classic paddy-wheat procurement; agency operations, arrivals and scheme conditions determine actual purchase.

Answer: D. Explanation: Oilseed procurement is not an everywhere-unlimited operation equivalent to classic paddy-wheat procurement; agency operations, arrivals and scheme conditions determine actual purchase. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Crop-list and millet caution?

A. The owner distinguishes notified price-support crops, sugarcane's separate FRP mechanism and millet or niger-seed questions; exact current lists, rates and season claims require the relevant notification. B. The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends MSPs, while the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs takes the Union-level announcement decision; recommendation and decision are distinct stages. C. A2 records paid-out expenses, A2+FL adds imputed family labour, and C2 further includes imputed rent on owned land and interest on owned fixed capital; the named base matters to any margin claim. D. Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owner distinguishes notified price-support crops, sugarcane's separate FRP mechanism and millet or niger-seed questions; exact current lists, rates and season claims require the relevant notification. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q78. Which option preserves the accounting or regulatory boundary of Crop-list and millet caution?

A. The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends MSPs, while the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs takes the Union-level announcement decision; recommendation and decision are distinct stages. B. The owner distinguishes notified price-support crops, sugarcane's separate FRP mechanism and millet or niger-seed questions; exact current lists, rates and season claims require the relevant notification. C. A2 records paid-out expenses, A2+FL adds imputed family labour, and C2 further includes imputed rent on owned land and interest on owned fixed capital; the named base matters to any margin claim. D. Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owner distinguishes notified price-support crops, sugarcane's separate FRP mechanism and millet or niger-seed questions; exact current lists, rates and season claims require the relevant notification. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q79. Which statement uses Crop-list and millet caution without losing its vintage, basket or legal status?

A. A2 records paid-out expenses, A2+FL adds imputed family labour, and C2 further includes imputed rent on owned land and interest on owned fixed capital; the named base matters to any margin claim. B. Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification. C. The owner distinguishes notified price-support crops, sugarcane's separate FRP mechanism and millet or niger-seed questions; exact current lists, rates and season claims require the relevant notification. D. Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owner distinguishes notified price-support crops, sugarcane's separate FRP mechanism and millet or niger-seed questions; exact current lists, rates and season claims require the relevant notification. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

Q80. Which option avoids the standard UPSC close-option trap about Crop-list and millet caution?

A. FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain. B. Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures. C. Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification. D. The owner distinguishes notified price-support crops, sugarcane's separate FRP mechanism and millet or niger-seed questions; exact current lists, rates and season claims require the relevant notification.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owner distinguishes notified price-support crops, sugarcane's separate FRP mechanism and millet or niger-seed questions; exact current lists, rates and season claims require the relevant notification. The other options belong to different measures, vintages, baskets, instruments, institutions or legal perimeters.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

Audited ledgers route Mains demands on MSP and low farm income, food-distribution reform, NFSA, PDS transparency, buffer-stock stabilisation and millets. Objective demands test the CCEA announcement role, FCI economic cost, rice-price drivers, limits of oilseed procurement and niger seed; no answer letter is inferred.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: 2024 GS-III: Importance of buffer stocks for price stabilisation and storage challenges.
- ANALYSIS: 2024 GS-III: Millets as a route to health and nutritional security.
- ANALYSIS: **Buffer-stock answer route:** separate MSP signal, procurement operations, buffer norms, storage cost, open-market release and PDS delivery; then show why excess or badly composed stocks create fiscal and logistical stress.
- ANALYSIS: **Millet answer route:** connect nutrition diversification, climate resilience and local suitability with procurement, processing, consumer demand and public-distribution constraints.
- ANALYSIS: **Unfamiliar-question route:** if asked about subsidy burden or FCI reform, pivot to CACP, FCI, NFSA, PMGKAY, Shanta Kumar Committee and the leakage-versus-guarantee trade-off.
- ANALYSIS: **PDS reform/transparency route (15-mark scale):** use the Section 5A reform bank - ONORC portability, end-to-end computerisation/ePoS-Aadhaar authentication, fortified rice, and the DBT/cash-transfer trade-off - each with its named limitation, rather than describing "digitisation" generically.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "9. PYQ application", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the Economy demand in "9. PYQ application".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** ANALYSIS: 2024 GS-III: Importance of buffer stocks for price stabilisation and storage challenges. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority

and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** ANALYSIS: 2024 GS-III: Millets as a route to health and nutritional security.

Analysis: Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** ANALYSIS: Millet answer route: connect nutrition diversification, climate resilience and local suitability with procurement, processing, consumer demand and public-distribution constraints.

Analysis: Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** ANALYSIS: Unfamiliar-question route: if asked about subsidy burden or FCI reform, pivot to CACP, FCI, NFSA, PMGKAY, Shanta Kumar Committee and the leakage-versus-guarantee trade-off. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the Economy demand in “9. PYQ application”.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “9. PYQ application”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2024-2025.md.

- **Years represented:** 2024
- **Paper(s):** GS-III
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	GS-III	4	Role of millets in health and nutritional security	Explain · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2024	GS-III	14	Importance of buffer stocks for price stabilization; storage challenges	Elucidate · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Role of millets in health and nutritional security
- Importance of buffer stocks for price stabilization; storage challenges

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2018-2023.md, _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md.

Answer-key rule: The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023
- **Paper(s):** GS-III, Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 9

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	GS-III	3	Minimum Support Price and farmer low income protection	Discuss · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2018	Prelims GS-I	93	MSP for crops announced by Cabinet Committee Economic Affairs	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2019	GS-III	13	Reformative steps to make food grain distribution system effective	Discuss · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2019	Prelims GS-I	79	Economic cost formula for food grains to FCI	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2020	Prelims GS-I	63	Factors affecting rice price in India recently	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2020	Prelims GS-I	69	MSP procurement unlimited status in Indian states oilseeds	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2021	GS-III	13	National Food Security Act 2013 features and hunger impact	What are · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	GS-III	3	Challenges of PDS and improving its effectiveness and transparency	Discuss · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2023	Prelims GS-I	27	Niger seed MSP cultivation season tribal communities	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- Minimum Support Price and farmer low income protection
- MSP for crops announced by Cabinet Committee Economic Affairs
- Reformative steps to make food grain distribution system effective
- Economic cost formula for food grains to FCI
- Factors affecting rice price in India recently
- MSP procurement unlimited status in Indian states oilseeds
- National Food Security Act 2013 features and hunger impact
- Challenges of PDS and improving its effectiveness and transparency
- Niger seed MSP cultivation season tribal communities

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: 2024 GS-III: Importance of buffer stocks for price stabilisation and storage challenges.

- ANALYSIS: 2024 GS-III: Millets as a route to health and nutritional security.

- ANALYSIS: **Millet answer engine:** nutrition and dietary diversity; climate/rainfed suitability where applicable; lower input or water pressure relative to local alternatives; then constraints in seed, yields, processing, procurement, consumer demand and value chains.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS3-GS4-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2018, 2019, 2021, 2022
- **Paper(s):** GS-III
- **Routed question demands:** 4

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2018	GS-III	3	Minimum Support Price and farmer low income protection	Discuss · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2019	GS-III	13	Reformative steps to make food grain distribution system effective	Discuss · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2021	GS-III	13	National Food Security Act 2013 features and hunger impact	What are · 15 marks · 250 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2022	GS-III	3	Challenges of PDS and improving its effectiveness and transparency	Discuss · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Minimum Support Price and farmer low income protection
- Reformative steps to make food grain distribution system effective
- National Food Security Act 2013 features and hunger impact
- Challenges of PDS and improving its effectiveness and transparency

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2018 GS-III

Demand: Discuss MSP as an instrument for protecting farmers from low income.

Status: Verified routed Mains demand; original model solution, not an official answer.

Model solution: MSP announcement: Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee. **CACP and CCEA:** The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends MSPs, while the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs takes the Union-level announcement decision; recommendation and decision are distinct stages. **Cost concepts:** A2 records paid-out expenses, A2+FL adds imputed family labour, and C2 further includes imputed rent on owned land and interest on owned fixed capital; the named base matters to any margin claim. **Procurement:** Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification. **Uneven procurement access:** Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2018 GS-III”, every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: MSP announcement: Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee. **CACP and CCEA:** The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends MSPs, while the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs takes the Union-level announcement decision; recommendation and decision are distinct stages. **Cost concepts:** A2 records paid-out expenses, A2+FL adds imputed family labour, and C2 further includes imputed rent on owned land and interest on owned fixed capital; the named base matters to any margin claim. **Procurement:** Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification. **Uneven procurement access:** Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Discuss MSP as an instrument for protecting farmers from low income. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** Status: Verified routed Mains demand; original model solution, not an official answer. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: MSP announcement: Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee. **CACP and**

CCEA: The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends MSPs, while the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs takes the Union-level announcement decision; recommendation and decision are distinct stages.

Cost concepts: A2 records paid-out expenses, A2+FL adds imputed family labour, and C2 further includes imputed rent on owned land and interest on owned fixed capital; the named base matters to any margin claim. **Procurement:** Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification. **Uneven procurement access:** Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2018 GS-III”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2019 GS-III

Demand: Suggest reforms to make foodgrain distribution more effective.

Status: Verified routed Mains demand; original model solution, not an official answer.

Model solution: NFSA and TPDS: The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. **Entitlement versus offtake:** A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. **ONORC portability:** One Nation One Ration Card enables portability within the NFSA delivery architecture, but portability use depends on beneficiary awareness, identity matching, ePoS connectivity and stock availability. **Digitisation trade-off:** End-to-end computerisation and ePoS authentication can reduce duplicate records and diversion, while device, connectivity, seeding or biometric failure can exclude genuine beneficiaries. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2019 GS-III”, every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: NFSA and TPDS: The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. **Entitlement versus offtake:** A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. **ONORC portability:** One Nation One Ration Card enables portability within the NFSA delivery architecture, but portability use depends on beneficiary awareness, identity matching, ePoS connectivity and stock availability. **Digitisation trade-off:** End-to-end computerisation and ePoS authentication can reduce duplicate records and diversion, while device, connectivity, seeding or biometric failure can exclude genuine beneficiaries. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Suggest reforms to make foodgrain distribution more effective. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect.

Qualification: State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Verified routed Mains demand; original model solution, not an official answer. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: NFSA and TPDS: The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. **Entitlement versus offtake:** A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. **ONORC portability:** One Nation One Ration Card enables portability within the NFSA delivery architecture, but portability use depends on beneficiary awareness, identity matching, ePoS connectivity and stock availability. **Digitisation trade-off:** End-to-end computerisation and ePoS authentication can reduce duplicate records and diversion, while device, connectivity, seeding or biometric failure can exclude genuine beneficiaries. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2019 GS-III”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2021 GS-III

Demand: Explain the NFSA architecture and assess its effect on hunger.

Status: Verified routed Mains demand; original model solution, not an official answer.

Model solution: NFSA and TPDS: The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. **NFSA entitlement units:** The owner records Priority Household entitlement per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana entitlement per household per month, so beneficiary category and accounting unit must not be mixed. **NFSA coverage ceilings:** The owner records NFSA coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent of rural population and 50 per cent of urban population; ceilings are not identical to actual enrolled beneficiaries in each state. **Entitlement versus offtake:** A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. **Nutrition dimensions:** Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Demand decoding: The directive answer requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2021 GS-III”, every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: NFSA and TPDS: The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. **NFSA entitlement units:** The owner records Priority Household entitlement per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana entitlement per household per month, so beneficiary category and accounting unit must not be mixed. **NFSA coverage ceilings:** The owner records NFSA coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent of rural population and 50 per cent of urban population; ceilings are not identical to actual enrolled beneficiaries in each state. **Entitlement versus offtake:** A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. **Nutrition dimensions:** Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Explain the NFSA architecture and assess its effect on hunger.
Analysis: Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Verified routed Mains demand; original model solution, not an official answer. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: NFSA and TPDS: The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. **NFSA entitlement units:** The owner records Priority Household entitlement per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana entitlement per household per month, so beneficiary category and accounting unit must not be mixed. **NFSA coverage ceilings:** The owner records NFSA coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent of rural population and 50 per cent of urban population; ceilings are not identical to actual enrolled beneficiaries in each state. **Entitlement versus offtake:** A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. **Nutrition dimensions:** Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 3 - 2021 GS-III", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2022 GS-III

Demand: Discuss PDS challenges and measures for effectiveness and transparency.

Status: Verified routed Mains demand; original model solution, not an official answer.

Model solution: NFSA and TPDS: The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. **Entitlement versus offtake:** A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. **ONORC portability:** One Nation One Ration Card enables portability within the NFSA delivery architecture, but portability use depends on beneficiary awareness, identity matching, ePoS connectivity and stock availability. **Digitisation trade-off:** End-to-end computerisation and ePoS authentication can reduce duplicate records and diversion, while device, connectivity, seeding or biometric failure can exclude genuine beneficiaries. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2022 GS-III”, every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: NFSA and TPDS: The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. **Entitlement versus offtake:** A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. **ONORC portability:** One Nation One Ration Card enables portability within the NFSA delivery architecture, but portability use depends on beneficiary awareness, identity matching, ePoS connectivity and stock availability. **Digitisation trade-off:** End-to-end computerisation and ePoS authentication can reduce duplicate records and diversion, while device, connectivity, seeding or biometric failure can exclude genuine beneficiaries. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Discuss PDS challenges and measures for effectiveness and transparency. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Verified routed Mains demand; original model solution, not an official answer. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: NFSA and TPDS: The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. **Entitlement versus offtake:** A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. **ONORC portability:** One Nation One Ration Card enables portability within the NFSA delivery architecture, but portability use depends on beneficiary awareness, identity matching, ePoS connectivity and stock availability. **Digitisation trade-off:** End-to-end computerisation and ePoS authentication can reduce duplicate records and diversion, while device, connectivity, seeding or biometric failure can exclude genuine beneficiaries. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “PYQ DEMAND CARD 4 - 2022 GS-III”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 5 - 2024 GS-III

Demand: Elucidate the importance of buffer stocks for price stabilisation and the storage challenge.

Status: Verified routed Mains demand; original model solution, not an official answer.

Model solution: FCI economic cost: FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain. **Buffer-stock boundary:** Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date. **Open-market release:** Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct. **Price stabilisation:** Public purchase can support farm prices and later stock release can moderate consumer prices, but excessive or unpredictable intervention can crowd private storage and distort crop choice. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 5 - 2024 GS-III”, every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: FCI economic cost: FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain. **Buffer-stock boundary:** Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date. **Open-market release:** Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct. **Price stabilisation:** Public purchase can support farm prices and later stock release can moderate consumer prices, but excessive or unpredictable intervention can crowd private storage and distort crop choice. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Elucidate the importance of buffer stocks for price stabilisation and the storage challenge. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Verified routed Mains demand; original model solution, not an official answer. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional

benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: FCI economic cost: FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain.

Buffer-stock boundary: Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date. **Open-market release:** Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct. **Price stabilisation:** Public purchase can support farm prices and later stock release can moderate consumer prices, but excessive or unpredictable intervention can crowd private storage and distort crop choice. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 5 - 2024 GS-III", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 6 - 2024 GS-III

Demand: Explain the role of millets in health and nutritional security.

Status: Verified routed Mains demand; original model solution, not an official answer.

Model solution: Nutrition dimensions: Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care. **Crop-list and millet caution:** The owner distinguishes notified price-support crops, sugarcane's separate FRP mechanism and millet or niger-seed questions; exact current lists, rates and season claims require the relevant notification. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 6 - 2024 GS-III", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Nutrition dimensions: Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care.

Crop-list and millet caution: The owner distinguishes notified price-support crops, sugarcane's separate FRP mechanism and millet or niger-seed questions; exact current lists, rates and season claims require the relevant notification. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Demand: Explain the role of millets in health and nutritional security. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Verified routed Mains demand; original model solution, not an official answer. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Nutrition dimensions: Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care.

Crop-list and millet caution: The owner distinguishes notified price-support crops, sugarcane's separate FRP mechanism and millet or niger-seed questions; exact current lists, rates and season claims require the relevant notification. The answer therefore separates definition, mechanism, evidence and limitation, and does not infer an official model answer or objective key.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 6 - 2024 GS-III", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish MSP recommendation, announcement and procurement. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: MSP announcement. **Named evidence/example:** Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** CACP and CCEA. **Named evidence/example:** The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends MSPs, while the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs takes the Union-level announcement decision; recommendation and decision are distinct stages. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Procurement. **Named evidence/example:** Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Uneven procurement access. **Named evidence/example:** Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and

geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee.
- The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends MSPs, while the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs takes the Union-level announcement decision; recommendation and decision are distinct stages.
- Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification.
- Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: MSP announcement. **Named evidence/example:** Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** CACP and CCEA. **Named evidence/example:** The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends MSPs, while the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs takes the Union-level announcement decision; recommendation and decision are distinct stages. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Procurement. **Named evidence/example:** Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Uneven procurement access. **Named evidence/example:** Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Distinguish MSP recommendation, announcement and procurement. Answer in about 150 words.”, every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: MSP announcement. **Named evidence/example:** Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** CACP and CCEA. **Named evidence/example:** The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends MSPs, while the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs takes the Union-level announcement decision; recommendation and decision are distinct stages. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and

geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Procurement. **Named evidence/example:** Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Uneven procurement access. **Named evidence/example:** Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends MSPs, while the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs takes the Union-level announcement decision; recommendation and decision are distinct stages. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** MSP announcement. **Named evidence/example:** Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** CACP and CCEA. **Named evidence/example:** The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices recommends MSPs, while the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs takes the Union-level announcement decision; recommendation and decision are distinct stages. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The

conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Procurement. **Named evidence/example:** Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Uneven procurement access. **Named evidence/example:** Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Distinguish MSP recommendation, announcement and procurement. Answer in about 150 words.”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain why the cost concept changes an MSP-margin claim. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Claim: Cost concepts. **Named evidence/example:** A2 records paid-out expenses, A2+FL adds imputed family labour, and C2 further includes imputed rent on owned land and interest on owned fixed capital; the named base matters to any margin claim. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- A2 records paid-out expenses, A2+FL adds imputed family labour, and C2 further includes imputed rent on owned land and interest on owned fixed capital; the named base matters to any margin claim.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Cost concepts. **Named evidence/example:** A2 records paid-out expenses, A2+FL adds imputed family labour, and C2 further includes imputed rent on owned land and interest on owned fixed capital; the named base matters to any margin claim. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on “Explain why the cost concept changes an MSP-margin claim. Answer in about 150 words.”, every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: Cost concepts. **Named evidence/example:** A2 records paid-out expenses, A2+FL adds imputed family labour, and C2 further includes imputed rent on owned land and interest on owned fixed capital; the named base matters to any margin claim. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** A2 records paid-out expenses, A2+FL adds imputed family labour, and C2 further includes imputed rent on owned land and interest on owned fixed capital; the named base matters to any margin claim. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Cost concepts. **Named evidence/example:** A2 records paid-out expenses, A2+FL adds imputed family labour, and C2 further includes imputed rent on owned land and interest on owned fixed capital; the named base matters to any margin claim. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Explain why the cost concept changes an MSP-margin claim. Answer in about 150 words.”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Trace FCI economic cost and the public-stock cycle. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Claim: FCI economic cost. **Named evidence/example:** FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Buffer-stock boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on

output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Open-market release. **Named evidence/example:** Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain.
- Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date.
- Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** FCI economic cost. **Named evidence/example:** FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Buffer-stock boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Open-market release. **Named evidence/example:** Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **trace** requires a direct position on "Trace FCI economic cost and the public-stock cycle. Answer in about 250 words.", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** FCI economic cost. **Named evidence/example:** FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Buffer-stock boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Open-market release. **Named**

evidence/example: Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: FCI economic cost. **Named evidence/example:** FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Buffer-stock boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Open-market release. **Named evidence/example:** Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag,

causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Trace FCI economic cost and the public-stock cycle. Answer in about 250 words.”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Distinguish NFSA entitlement, TPDS delivery and actual offtake. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** NFSA and TPDS. **Named evidence/example:** The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** NFSA entitlement units. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records Priority Household entitlement per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana entitlement per household per month, so beneficiary category and accounting unit must not be mixed. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** NFSA coverage ceilings. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records NFSA coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent of rural population and 50 per cent of urban population; ceilings are not identical to actual enrolled beneficiaries in each state. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Entitlement versus offtake. **Named evidence/example:** A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical.
- The owner records Priority Household entitlement per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana entitlement per household per month, so beneficiary category and accounting unit must not be mixed.
- The owner records NFSA coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent of rural population and 50 per cent of urban population; ceilings are not identical to actual enrolled beneficiaries in each state.
- A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** NFSA and TPDS. **Named evidence/example:** The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** NFSA entitlement units. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records Priority Household entitlement per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana entitlement per household per month, so beneficiary

category and accounting unit must not be mixed. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** NFSA coverage ceilings. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records NFSA coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent of rural population and 50 per cent of urban population; ceilings are not identical to actual enrolled beneficiaries in each state. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Entitlement versus offtake. **Named evidence/example:** A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Distinguish NFSA entitlement, TPDS delivery and actual offtake. Answer in about 250 words.”, every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** NFSA and TPDS. **Named evidence/example:** The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** NFSA entitlement units. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records Priority Household entitlement per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana entitlement per household per month, so beneficiary category and accounting unit must not be mixed. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** NFSA coverage ceilings. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records NFSA coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent of rural population and 50 per cent of urban population; ceilings are not identical to actual enrolled beneficiaries in each state. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Entitlement versus offtake. **Named evidence/example:** A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** The owner records Priority Household entitlement per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana entitlement per household per month, so beneficiary category and accounting unit must not be mixed. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The owner records NFSA coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent of rural population and 50 per cent of urban population; ceilings are not identical to actual enrolled beneficiaries in each state. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: NFSA and TPDS. **Named evidence/example:** The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** NFSA entitlement units. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records Priority Household entitlement per person per month and Antyodaya Anna Yojana entitlement per household per month, so beneficiary category and accounting unit must not be mixed. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** NFSA coverage ceilings. **Named evidence/example:** The owner records NFSA coverage ceilings of up to 75 per cent of rural population and 50 per cent of urban population; ceilings are not identical to actual enrolled beneficiaries in each state. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Entitlement versus offtake. **Named evidence/example:** A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Distinguish NFSA entitlement, TPDS delivery and actual offtake. Answer in about 250 words.”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Evaluate India's food-management system from procurement to price stabilisation. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: **Claim:** Procurement. **Named evidence/example:** Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** FCI economic cost. **Named evidence/example:** FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Buffer-stock boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Open-market release. **Named evidence/example:** Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Decentralised procurement. **Named evidence/example:** Decentralised procurement gives participating states a larger operational role in purchase, storage and distribution, without eliminating Union financing, stock-transfer or quality questions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Price stabilisation. **Named evidence/example:** Public purchase can support farm prices and later stock release can moderate consumer prices, but excessive or unpredictable intervention can crowd private storage and distort crop choice. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification.
- FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain.

- Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date.
- Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct.
- Decentralised procurement gives participating states a larger operational role in purchase, storage and distribution, without eliminating Union financing, stock-transfer or quality questions.
- Public purchase can support farm prices and later stock release can moderate consumer prices, but excessive or unpredictable intervention can crowd private storage and distort crop choice.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** Procurement. **Named evidence/example:** Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** FCI economic cost. **Named evidence/example:** FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Buffer-stock boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Open-market release. **Named evidence/example:** Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Decentralised procurement. **Named evidence/example:** Decentralised procurement gives participating states a larger operational role in purchase, storage and distribution, without eliminating Union financing, stock-transfer or quality questions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Price stabilisation. **Named evidence/example:** Public purchase can support farm prices and later stock release can moderate consumer prices, but excessive or unpredictable intervention can crowd private storage and distort crop choice. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **evaluate** requires a direct position on "Evaluate India's food-management system from procurement to price stabilisation. Answer in...", every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** Procurement. **Named evidence/example:** Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain

the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** FCI economic cost. **Named evidence/example:** FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Buffer-stock boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Open-market release. **Named evidence/example:** Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Decentralised procurement. **Named evidence/example:** Decentralised procurement gives participating states a larger operational role in purchase, storage and distribution, without eliminating Union financing, stock-transfer or quality questions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Price stabilisation. **Named evidence/example:** Public purchase can support farm prices and later stock release can moderate consumer prices, but excessive or unpredictable intervention can crowd private storage and distort crop choice. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct.

Analysis: Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

5. **Claim and named evidence:** Decentralised procurement gives participating states a larger operational role in purchase, storage and distribution, without eliminating Union financing, stock-transfer or quality questions.

Analysis: Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

6. **Claim and named evidence:** Public purchase can support farm prices and later stock release can moderate consumer prices, but excessive or unpredictable intervention can crowd private storage and distort crop choice.

Analysis: Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: Procurement. **Named evidence/example:** Procurement is actual agency purchase of eligible produce under specified crop, grade, season, geography and operational conditions; it must not be inferred from MSP notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** FCI economic cost. **Named evidence/example:** FCI's economic cost is broader than MSP because procurement incidentals, movement, storage, carrying and distribution-related costs enter the public food-management chain.

Analysis: This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Buffer-stock boundary. **Named evidence/example:** Buffer stock is publicly held inventory for operational distribution, strategic security and stabilisation; buffer norms are desired benchmarks, not the actual stock on every date. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Open-market release. **Named evidence/example:** Open Market Sale Scheme releases address broader market supply and price conditions, while PDS releases serve household entitlements; the channels and purposes must remain distinct. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability.

Qualification: The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Decentralised procurement. **Named evidence/example:** Decentralised procurement gives participating states a larger operational role in purchase, storage and distribution, without eliminating Union financing, stock-transfer or quality questions. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Price stabilisation. **Named evidence/example:** Public purchase can support farm prices and later stock release can moderate consumer prices, but excessive or unpredictable intervention can crowd private storage and distort crop choice. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the

effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Evaluate India's food-management system from procurement to price stabilisation. Answer in...”, replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: How can food security balance farmer support, consumer access, nutrition and fiscal discipline? Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Claim: MSP announcement. **Named evidence/example:** Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Uneven procurement access. **Named evidence/example:** Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** NFSA and TPDS. **Named evidence/example:** The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Entitlement versus offtake. **Named evidence/example:** A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Nutrition dimensions. **Named evidence/example:** Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Crop-list and millet caution. **Named evidence/example:** The owner distinguishes notified price-support crops, sugarcane's separate FRP mechanism and millet or niger-seed questions; exact current lists, rates and season claims require the relevant notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage,

base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee.
- Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures.
- The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical.
- A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure.
- Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care.
- The owner distinguishes notified price-support crops, sugarcane's separate FRP mechanism and millet or niger-seed questions; exact current lists, rates and season claims require the relevant notification.

Qualified conclusion: **Claim:** MSP announcement. **Named evidence/example:** Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Uneven procurement access. **Named evidence/example:** Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** NFSA and TPDS. **Named evidence/example:** The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Entitlement versus offtake. **Named evidence/example:** A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Nutrition dimensions. **Named evidence/example:** Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Crop-list and millet caution. **Named evidence/example:** The owner distinguishes notified price-support crops, sugarcane's separate FRP mechanism and millet or niger-seed questions; exact current lists, rates and season claims require the relevant notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “How can food security balance farmer support, consumer access, nutrition and fiscal...”, every clause, exact formula/category, institution and policy status, a monetary-fiscal-real-external transmission chain with lags, named Indian evidence, distribution/federal effects, trade-offs and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: **Claim:** MSP announcement. **Named evidence/example:** Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Uneven procurement access. **Named evidence/example:** Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** NFSA and TPDS. **Named evidence/example:** The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Entitlement versus offtake. **Named evidence/example:** A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Nutrition dimensions. **Named evidence/example:** Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Crop-list and millet caution. **Named evidence/example:** The owner distinguishes notified price-support crops, sugarcane's separate FRP mechanism and millet or niger-seed questions; exact current lists, rates and season claims require the relevant notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status,

source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** The owner distinguishes notified price-support crops, sugarcane's separate FRP mechanism and millet or niger-seed questions; exact current lists, rates and season claims require the relevant notification. **Analysis:** Connect the identity/category and named Indian evidence -> instrument, price, quantity, balance-sheet or incentive channel -> implementation and lag -> growth, employment, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effect. **Qualification:** State unit/denominator, stock/flow, nominal/real, authority and programme status, source-date-reference period, causal limit, counterfactual, trade-off or residual risk.

Counter-position / limit: An accounting identity, index movement, allocation, rate change, notification, platform count, WTO notification or chronological association cannot alone establish transmission, utilisation, distributional benefit or attributable outcome; test mechanism, lag, counterfactual, data vintage, implementation and external/federal constraints.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: MSP announcement. **Named evidence/example:** Minimum Support Price is an announced price signal and downside-support instrument; announcement alone is not a universal legal purchase or income guarantee. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Uneven procurement access. **Named evidence/example:** Effective support varies by crop, state, market arrivals, agency presence and quality compliance, so announced coverage and realised procurement are different measures. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** NFSA and TPDS. **Named evidence/example:** The National Food Security Act provides a statutory entitlement architecture, while the Targeted Public Distribution System is the principal delivery network; law and delivery operation are not identical. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Entitlement versus offtake. **Named evidence/example:** A legal allocation or entitlement does not prove household offtake, consumption, nutritional utilisation or error-free delivery; each is a separate outcome measure. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than

generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Nutrition dimensions. **Named evidence/example:** Food security includes availability, economic access, utilisation or nutrition and stability; cereal distribution alone cannot substitute for diverse diets, sanitation, health and care. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source. **Claim:** Crop-list and millet caution. **Named evidence/example:** The owner distinguishes notified price-support crops, sugarcane's separate FRP mechanism and millet or niger-seed questions; exact current lists, rates and season claims require the relevant notification. **Analysis:** This identifies the economic mechanism, the relevant institution or accounting boundary, and the effect on output, prices, distribution or financial stability. **Qualification:** The conclusion must retain the stated period, estimate vintage, base year, basket, instrument eligibility, crop and geography scope, implementation stage, stock-flow distinction or legal perimeter rather than generalise beyond the source.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing definition/identity -> instrument or shock -> transmission -> growth, distribution, stability, sustainability and federal effects; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for unit, denominator, data vintage, legal/programme status, lag, causation and residual-risk checks.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses India-centric evidence and preserves formula, stock-flow, institutional, status, data-vintage, distributional and causal distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "How can food security balance farmer support, consumer access, nutrition and fiscal...", replace the weakest catalogue point with one exact formula or classification, named institution/instrument, balance-sheet or incentive channel, lag, measurable outcome, distribution/federal effect and qualification.